

ZAY-MARIE PRESS | DIGITAL STUDIES SERIES

Study Connections Guide

A question-based reading guide to all 58 Digital Studies

Each study answers a defined question. This companion explains what a connected study adds, why that connection helps, and where to read next. Follow the linked titles to preview each study on the website.

Choose a Question

Israel, the Body, and covenant identity

Who receives a promise, and what does shared blessing establish? Studies 1, 4, 9, 12, 13, 17, 21, 35, 36, 39, 40, 56, 41, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55.

Acts, apostolic commissions, and present obligation

Which actions and commands in Acts govern the Body today? Studies 2, 6, 11, 14, 18, 19, 20, 25, 34, 38, 42, 43.

Life and standing in Christ

How does the Body's position in Christ shape life now? Studies 5, 16, 22, 30, 37, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 57.

Prophecy and future events

Which audiences and periods do prophetic passages name? Studies 3, 7, 8, 10, 23, 26, 27, 29, 49.

Difficult passages and interpretive systems

How do we keep an argument's own context and question intact? Studies 15, 24, 28, 32, 58.

Judgment and reward

How do different judgments and reward images relate? Studies 31, 33.

Study numbers identify catalog entries; they do not prescribe a single reading sequence. Every study remains available individually.

Israel, the Body, and covenant identity

Who receives a promise, and what does shared blessing establish?

Study 1 — The Bride of Christ

What this study answers. Study 1 tests where Scripture places bridal language and what Paul's marriage imagery establishes for the Body of Christ.

- **Study 12 — The New Covenant** — Read Jeremiah's New Covenant promise with its named recipients in view; this keeps the prophetic marriage theme and covenant promise in their own setting.
- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Use the larger Israel and Body comparison to see why a shared image or figure does not by itself assign both groups the same corporate identity.

Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ

What this study answers. Study 4 establishes the corporate distinction between Israel and the Body of Christ across covenants, callings, promises, and destinies.

- **Study 36 — Jews, Gentiles, and the Church of God** — Apply that distinction to Paul's Jews, Gentiles, and Church of God categories; it clarifies how Jewish or Gentile origin relates to membership in one Body.
- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Carry the distinction into Bible reading: learn from Israel's Scriptures while keeping the recipients of its commands and national promises in view.

Study 9 — The Remnant

What this study answers. Study 9 follows the believing remnant within Israel, including Paul's argument in Romans 11.

- **Study 21 — Israel's Judicial Blinding** — Read corporate judicial blinding alongside the remnant's continued existence. This explains how Israel can face national hardening without every Israelite being hardened.
- **Study 23 — The 144,000** — Examine Revelation's numbered tribal company as a particular group; it prevents the 144,000 from being equated with every faithful Israelite in every period.
- **Study 50 — Election** — See the remnant's election of grace set alongside Israel's national election and the Body's election in Christ — this study's own ground within the larger pattern Study 50 traces.

Study 12 — The New Covenant

What this study answers. Study 12 identifies the New Covenant's named recipients and promises in Jeremiah 31 and Ezekiel 36.

- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Work through how the Body may learn from a covenant addressed to Israel and Judah without acquiring its national identity or every covenant obligation.
- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Place the covenant within the wider distinction between Israel and the Body of Christ; this clarifies why Christ's saving work and the covenant's named parties are separate questions.
- **Study 53 — Redemption** — Distinguish this covenant's own ratifying blood from the price that redemption itself names, so that a shared use of "blood" does not collapse two distinct functions into one.

Study 13 — The Olive Tree and the Body of Christ

What this study answers. Study 13 interprets Paul's olive-tree image in Romans 11 and the participation of Gentiles in the patriarchal root's blessing.

- **Study 17 — The Abrahamic Covenant** — Return to the covenant's actual terms in Genesis; those promises explain the root without turning all beneficiaries into Israel or transferring the land promise.
- **Study 40 — Who Is Abraham's Seed?** — Follow Paul's several uses of Abraham's seed in Romans and Galatians; this tests exactly what faith, blessing, and heirship grant before drawing identity conclusions.
- **Study 9 — The Remnant** — Identify the believing Israelite remnant within Romans 11; it clarifies whom Paul means among the natural branches.

Study 17 — The Abrahamic Covenant

What this study answers. Study 17 establishes the Abrahamic covenant's line, nation, land, and blessing in its Genesis setting.

- **Study 40 — Who Is Abraham's Seed?** — Trace Paul's uses of Abraham and his seed in Romans and Galatians; this shows which benefits he extends to believers and which covenant terms he does not reassign.
- **Study 13 — The Olive Tree and the Body of Christ** — Read Romans 11's olive-tree image against that covenant background; it clarifies how Gentiles share in patriarchal blessing without becoming Israel.
- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Apply a method for learning from Genesis while preserving the original recipients of national and land promises.

Study 21 — Israel’s Judicial Blinding

What this study answers. Study 21 traces Israel’s corporate judicial blinding in Romans 11 and Acts 28.

- **Study 9 — The Remnant** — Follow the believing remnant through the same national history; its existence explains why corporate hardening does not erase every Israelite’s faith.
- **Study 13 — The Olive Tree and the Body of Christ** — Read Paul’s natural branches, wild branch, and future reception in Romans 11; the olive-tree illustration makes the consequences and limits of hardening more precise.

Study 35 — Who Is the Israel of God?

What this study answers. Study 35 tests the expressions ‘Israel of God’ and ‘a Jew inwardly’ and the later label ‘spiritual Israel’ in context.

- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Use the broader Israel and Body distinction to evaluate whether a disputed expression actually changes either group’s corporate identity.
- **Study 36 — Jews, Gentiles, and the Church of God** — Examine Paul’s categories in 1 Corinthians 10:32; they give a separate check on whether Jewish origin, Gentile origin, and Church membership are being conflated.
- **Study 40 — Who Is Abraham’s Seed?** — Test whether sharing Abrahamic blessing through faith makes someone Israelite; Paul’s seed language helps answer an identity inference often brought to Galatians 6:16.

Study 36 — Jews, Gentiles, and the Church of God

What this study answers. Study 36 reads Jews, Gentiles, and the Church of God in 1 Corinthians 10:32 and distinguishes historical origin from standing in one Body.

- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Set these three categories within the broader corporate distinction between Israel and the Body; this explains why origin and present membership answer different questions.
- **Study 35 — Who Is the Israel of God?** — Test contested labels such as ‘Israel of God’ against Paul’s categories instead of using one debated phrase to erase distinctions elsewhere.

Study 39 — The Church’s Relationship to Israel’s Scriptures

What this study answers. Study 39 gives a method for learning from Israel’s Scriptures while retaining their original audience and covenant setting.

- **Study 17 — The Abrahamic Covenant** — Practice the method on the Abrahamic covenant in Genesis: identify its line, national promises, and blessing before claiming present application.
- **Study 40 — Who Is Abraham’s Seed?** — See how Paul uses that history in Romans and Galatians; his specific arguments provide a worked example of learning from Israel’s Scriptures without transferring Israelite identity.
- **Study 38 — Why Acts Is Not a Universal Experience Manual** — Apply related audience and authority questions to events narrated in Acts, where the issue is whether an action creates a present obligation.

Study 40 — Who Is Abraham's Seed?

What this study answers. Study 40 tests what Paul means by Abraham's seed, faith, blessing, and heirship in Romans and Galatians.

- **Study 17 — The Abrahamic Covenant** — Begin with the covenant's original terms in Genesis; its selected line, land, nation, and blessing set the baseline for evaluating Paul's later claims.
- **Study 13 — The Olive Tree and the Body of Christ** — Compare Romans 11's olive-tree image with Paul's seed language; the comparison clarifies why sharing patriarchal blessing need not assign Israelite identity.
- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Use the broader reading method for Israel's Scriptures to see why Paul's application of Abraham's history must be established passage by passage.

Study 56 — Inheritance

What this study answers. Study 56 identifies the giver, heir, promised object, basis, and timing in inheritance texts. It compares Israel's named land promise with Paul's account of heirship in Christ and Peter's inheritance reserved in heaven, without treating a shared word as a shared possession.

- **Study 5 — The Heavenly Calling** — Place Paul's inheritance language within the Body's wider heavenly identity, blessings, citizenship, and hope; then return to Study 56 for the narrower question of what an heir receives.
- **Study 17 — The Abrahamic Covenant** — Start with Genesis's named line, land, and blessing so a later shared word does not erase the original grant or its recipients.
- **Study 40 — Who Is Abraham's Seed?** — Follow Paul's argument about seed and promise in Romans and Galatians before comparing heirship with Ephesians, Colossians, and 1 Peter.
- **Study 52 — Sonship and Adoption** — Establish how the believer receives sonship, then distinguish that status from the further question of the inheritance named for the heir.
- **Study 57 — The Eternal Purpose of God** — Read Ephesians 1-3 on purpose and headship after Study 56 identifies the heirs and objects each inheritance passage names; one comprehensive purpose does not silently transfer Israel's land grant.

Study 41 — Kingdom of God or Kingdom of Heaven?

What this study answers. Study 41 tests whether the kingdom of heaven and the kingdom of God are different kingdoms and identifies whose kingdom each text describes.

- **Study 2 — The Gospel of the Kingdom** — Study the Kingdom message itself—its audience, promises, and required response—after this study establishes what the two kingdom phrases name.
- **Study 5 — The Heavenly Calling** — Develop the Body's heavenly identity, position, and hope, which this study distinguishes from Israel's earthly kingdom inheritance.
- **Study 21 — Israel's Judicial Blinding** — Examine the Acts 28 suspension that frames this study's reading of Paul's final kingdom preaching in Acts 28:31.

Study 50 — Election

What this study answers. Study 50 traces the two elections Scripture names — Israel's national election and the Body's election in Christ — and the discipline that keeps a shared word from becoming a shared doctrine.

- **Study 9 — The Remnant** — Compare the corporate, national election traced here with the narrower "election of grace" this study locates within it — an individual outworking, not a separate election.
- **Study 21 — Israel's Judicial Blinding** — See the national judicial suspension examined in full — the present, corporate condition this study calls on to show why Israel's unbelief never revokes her ongoing election.
- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Read the broad Israel-Body distinction in origin, covenant, and destiny that this study's narrower question about election depends on throughout.

Study 51 — Circumcision

What this study answers. Study 51 traces the two circumcisions Scripture names — Israel's fleshly covenant sign and the Body's circumcision of Christ — and the discipline that keeps a shared word from becoming a shared doctrine.

- **Study 17 — The Abrahamic Covenant** — See the covenant that circumcision was given to seal in Genesis 17, and the broader promise this study's narrower sign belongs to.
- **Study 19 — The Jerusalem Council** — Examine in full the council this study calls on as its test case for whether circumcision could be required of Gentile believers.
- **Study 42 — One Baptism** — Compare the Body's other non-fleshly, in-Christ reality, read alongside Colossians 2:11-13's own pairing of circumcision and baptism as the same union with Christ.

Study 52 — Sonship and Adoption

What this study answers. Study 52 traces the two sonships Scripture names by adoption — Israel's national sonship claimed at the exodus and named in Romans 9:4, and the Body's own adoption in Christ — and the discipline that keeps a shared word from becoming a shared doctrine.

- **Study 50 — Election** — See the antecedent choosing this study's placing into sonship presupposes, and how Israel's national election and the Body's election in Christ likewise remain two distinct realities under one shared word.
- **Study 5 — The Heavenly Calling** — Read the wider heavenly calling this study's Ephesians 1 adoption belongs to — the fuller scope of blessings, citizenship, and hope the Body possesses in Christ.
- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Review the broad distinction in origin, identity, covenant, calling, and destiny that this study's narrower adoption contrast depends on throughout.

Study 53 — Redemption

What this study answers. Study 53 traces the two redemptions Scripture names — Israel's historical and future national deliverance and the Body's own redemption in Christ — and the discipline of company, price, and timing that keeps a shared word from becoming a shared doctrine.

- **Study 52 — Sonship and Adoption** — See the legal placing into sonship that this study's own Galatians 4:4-5 redemption secures, a distinct question from the price and bondage redemption itself names.
- **Study 46 — Secure in Christ** — Read the fuller argument for the believer's settled security that this study's own Ephesians 1:13-14 reference touches only for what it says about redemption's still-future stage.
- **Study 12 — The New Covenant** — Examine the New Covenant's own ratifying blood in its own setting, distinguished in this study from the price that redemption itself names.
- **Study 55 — Reconciled to God** — Follow the distinct question of former enmity and peace with God after identifying redemption's price.

Study 54 — Justification

What this study answers. Study 54 traces justification as a legal verdict — its ground in Christ's finished work, its means by faith alone, and its pattern already given to Abraham before the law — against Israel's own stumbling pursuit of a law-righteousness.

- **Study 53 — Redemption** — Trace the price redemption itself names in Romans 3:24, a distinct question from the verdict that price secures.
- **Study 15 — Faith and Works in James and Paul** — Read James 2 and Romans 4 each within its own stated audience, distinguishing a living faith's proof from justification's own ground.
- **Study 40 — Who Is Abraham's Seed?** — Follow what Paul means by Abraham's seed, faith, and heirship across Romans and Galatians, a distinct question from Abraham's own justification by faith.
- **Study 55 — Reconciled to God** — Follow the distinct question of former enmity and peace with God after identifying justification's verdict.

Study 55 — Reconciled to God

What this study answers. Study 55 follows Paul's account of former enmity, God's reconciling work in Christ, peace received, and the appeal entrusted to ambassadors. It reads Romans 5, 2 Corinthians 5, Ephesians 2, and Colossians 1 without turning the breadth of the message into universal personal reception.

- **Study 53 — Redemption** — Identify the bondage and price named by redemption before asking the different relational question of what peace Christ's work establishes.
- **Study 54 — Justification** — Establish the verdict received by faith in Romans 3-5; then see why Romans 5:1 calls peace with God its present result.
- **Study 37 — What Does Paul Mean by "New Creation"?** — Read 2 Corinthians 5:17 in its own setting so the following reconciliation passage is connected to, but not substituted for, Paul's new-creation claim.
- **Study 52 — Sonship and Adoption** — Compare reconciliation's answer to enmity and peace with adoption's distinct question of sonship and inheritance.

Acts, apostolic commissions, and present obligation

Which actions and commands in Acts govern the Body today?

Study 2 — The Gospel of the Kingdom

What this study answers. Study 2 establishes the Kingdom message: to whom it was announced, what it promised, and how its hearers were called to respond.

- **Study 20 — Understanding Acts 2:38** — Examine Peter’s actual response to Israel at Pentecost, including repentance, baptism, remission, and the promised Spirit. The Kingdom setting clarifies why Acts 2:38 should be read in its own audience and prophetic setting.
- **Study 18 — Peter and Paul: Distinct Apostolic Commissions** — Compare Peter’s and Paul’s commissions during the Acts overlap. Their distinct assignments explain why Peter’s Kingdom proclamation and Paul’s ministry must be compared without merging them.
- **Study 41 — Kingdom of God or Kingdom of Heaven?** — Settle what the Gospels mean by “kingdom of heaven” and “kingdom of God” before studying the Kingdom message; the two phrases name the one kingdom promised to Israel.

Study 6 — The Mystery Revealed Through Paul

What this study answers. Study 6 defines the previously hidden Mystery revealed through Paul and identifies its content.

- **Study 11 — The Beginning of the Body of Christ** — Ask when the Body of Christ began; this lets you relate the revelation’s content to the beginning of the corporate people it concerns.
- **Study 14 — Acts 9 and the Beginning of Mystery** — Read Paul’s Acts 9 calling in the narrative while Peter’s ministry continues; this locates the Mystery commission within the period when both programs operated concurrently.
- **Study 57 — The Eternal Purpose of God** — After tracing what was hidden and revealed through Paul, read how Ephesians 3:10-11 connects that disclosure to the Church’s present witness of God’s wisdom.

Study 11 — The Beginning of the Body of Christ

What this study answers. Study 11 asks when the Body of Christ began in relation to Paul’s calling and the Mystery.

- **Study 14 — Acts 9 and the Beginning of Mystery** — Examine the Acts 9 event itself and what continues afterward; this gives the narrative evidence for the timing proposed here.
- **Study 6 — The Mystery Revealed Through Paul** — Identify what the Mystery revealed through Paul actually contains; that content helps explain why the Body is distinct rather than merely assigning it a starting date.

Study 14 — Acts 9 and the Beginning of Mystery

What this study answers. Study 14 focuses on Paul's Acts 9 calling as the beginning of his distinct Mystery commission while Peter's prophetic ministry continues.

- **Study 11 — The Beginning of the Body of Christ** — Develop the related timing question of the Body's beginning from the doctrinal evidence, rather than assuming that every Acts 9 detail answers it by itself.
- **Study 18 — Peter and Paul: Distinct Apostolic Commissions** — Follow the two apostolic commissions after Paul's call; their concurrent ministries show why the new commission did not end Peter's earlier assignment.

Study 18 — Peter and Paul: Distinct Apostolic Commissions

What this study answers. Study 18 compares Peter's and Paul's audiences, commissions, and ministries during the Acts overlap.

- **Study 19 — The Jerusalem Council** — Watch those distinct ministries meet at the Jerusalem Council. The specific circumcision dispute and the council's recognition of Gentile ministry put the apostolic comparison into an actual case.
- **Study 14 — Acts 9 and the Beginning of Mystery** — Trace Paul's earlier Acts 9 calling; it explains where the distinct commission in this comparison begins while Peter's line continues.

Study 19 — The Jerusalem Council

What this study answers. Study 19 examines the Acts 15 controversy, testimony, decree, and recognition of ministry to Gentiles.

- **Study 18 — Peter and Paul: Distinct Apostolic Commissions** — Establish the distinct commissions of the apostles present at the council; this keeps its shared deliberation from implying identical audiences and assignments.
- **Study 15 — Faith and Works in James and Paul** — Separate the council's circumcision question from James 2's treatment of faith and works; reading each dispute on its own terms prevents a false shortcut between them.
- **Study 51 — Circumcision** — Trace circumcision itself in full — Israel's fleshly sign, the Body's non-fleshly circumcision of Christ, and the two opposite errors a careful reader must avoid on either side of this council's own test case.

Study 20 — Understanding Acts 2:38

What this study answers. Study 20 reads Peter's commands and the promised Spirit in Acts 2:38 as part of his Pentecost appeal to Israel.

- **Study 2 — The Gospel of the Kingdom** — Recover the promised Kingdom and its audience before interpreting Peter's response; this makes clear why his hearers ask their question in Acts 2:37.
- **Study 34 — Filled Again** — Distinguish the Spirit promised at Pentecost from the apostles' later renewed filling in Acts 4, so different Spirit-related events are not treated as identical.
- **Study 38 — Why Acts Is Not a Universal Experience Manual** — Use the wider test for whether an event narrated in Acts establishes a present obligation for the Body.

Study 25 — The Signs That Followed

What this study answers. Study 25 reads Mark 16's signs with the commission, audience, and confirming purpose in view.

- **Study 38 — Why Acts Is Not a Universal Experience Manual** — Apply a broader test for moving from signs and other narrated events to present obligations; this helps determine what Mark 16's record authorizes today.
- **Study 34 — Filled Again** — Distinguish repeated Spirit filling in Acts from the sign promises connected to a particular commission; both concern divine enablement, but they answer different questions.
- **Study 42 — One Baptism** — See how Mark's baptism fits among the baptisms Scripture describes, and which baptism Paul identifies for the Body.

Study 34 — Filled Again

What this study answers. Study 34 explains why apostles could be filled again in Acts 4 without losing and regaining the Spirit.

- **Study 20 — Understanding Acts 2:38** — Read Peter's earlier Pentecost promise and his audience first; this distinguishes initial Spirit reception from the later renewed enablement recorded in Acts 4.
- **Study 38 — Why Acts Is Not a Universal Experience Manual** — Apply the Acts-reading test to repeated filling; it clarifies what a historical event teaches without making each occurrence a universal required sequence.
- **Study 44 — Walking in the Spirit** — Distinguish these renewed, repeated Acts-era fillings from the Body's settled, once-for-all indwelling ministry of the Spirit that this study examines.

Study 38 — Why Acts Is Not a Universal Experience Manual

What this study answers. Study 38 asks when an action narrated in Acts is instructive history and when it establishes a present obligation for the Body.

- **Study 20 — Understanding Acts 2:38** — Apply the test to Peter's commands at Pentecost, where audience and prophetic context control how Acts 2:38 is read.
- **Study 25 — The Signs That Followed** — Apply it to Mark 16's sign commission and its recorded effects, so a narrated sign is not assumed to bind every believer.
- **Study 34 — Filled Again** — Apply it to the apostles' renewed Spirit filling, distinguishing what Acts reports from a required sequence for all readers.
- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Carry the same audience and assignment questions into Israel's earlier Scriptures to move responsibly from original meaning to present application.

Study 42 — One Baptism

What this study answers. Study 42 defines baptism from Scripture and identifies from Paul's letters the one baptism that places believers into the Body of Christ.

- **Study 20 — Understanding Acts 2:38** — Read Peter's Pentecost command to Israel in detail; this study classifies it among the many baptisms Scripture describes.
- **Study 25 — The Signs That Followed** — Examine the Kingdom commission that joins belief and baptism in Mark 16, which this study distinguishes from Paul's commission.
- **Study 34 — Filled Again** — Follow the Spirit's fillings in Acts, which this study distinguishes from the Spirit's once-for-all baptism into the one Body.

Study 43 — The Gospel of the Grace of God

What this study answers. Study 43 defines Paul's gospel from 1 Corinthians 15 and Romans 3, addressed to all on the same terms, and relates it to the Mystery.

- **Study 2 — The Gospel of the Kingdom** — Read the Kingdom message Israel was called to believe; this study distinguishes it from Paul's gospel without merging their shared ground in Christ's finished work.
- **Study 6 — The Mystery Revealed Through Paul** — Examine the previously hidden truth Paul was given to reveal; this study relates that Mystery to the gospel he preached without collapsing the two.
- **Study 11 — The Beginning of the Body of Christ** — Ask when the Body began; this study identifies the gospel by which its members are justified, reconciled, and placed into that Body.

Life and standing in Christ

How does the Body's position in Christ shape life now?

Study 5 — The Heavenly Calling

What this study answers. Study 5 surveys the Body's heavenly identity, blessings, citizenship, hope, and future purpose.

- **Study 30 — Seated With Christ in Heavenly Places** — Examine the specific claim that believers are seated with Christ in Ephesians 2:6. It helps distinguish the text's established heavenly position from further claims about present authority and future governing service.
- **Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ** — Connect heavenly calling to the believer's present standing and conduct in Christ, so the larger calling is not treated only as a future destination.
- **Study 52 — Sonship and Adoption** — See the Body's own adoption in Ephesians 1:3–5 traced in full — one specific blessing within the wider heavenly calling this study surveys.
- **Study 57 — The Eternal Purpose of God** — Read how the Body's heavenly calling participates in the Church's present display of divine wisdom in Ephesians 3, while Study 5 surveys the calling itself.

Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ

What this study answers. Study 16 surveys the believer's identity and standing in Christ and how conduct flows from that standing.

- **Study 37 — What Does Paul Mean by “New Creation”?** — Examine Paul's new-creation language closely; it distinguishes an accomplished identity in Christ from ongoing renewal and moral practice.
- **Study 44 — Walking in the Spirit** — Follow how this settled identity works itself out day by day, in the conflict between the flesh and the Spirit and the fruit that walk produces.
- **Study 45 — Sanctification Under Grace** — Isolate one member of this identity — sanctification — and see why the believer is already sanctified in Christ before any command to grow follows.

Study 22 — Prayer Under Grace

What this study answers. Study 22 establishes prayer under grace from Paul while reading Kingdom prayer promises in their own setting.

- **Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ** — Place prayer within the believer's present standing in Christ; this helps relate confidence before God to daily practice without promising a particular change in circumstances.
- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Use the distinction between learning from earlier Scripture and claiming a promise addressed to another audience when reading prayer teaching outside Paul's letters.

Study 30 — Seated With Christ in Heavenly Places

What this study answers. Study 30 closely tests what being seated with Christ means in Ephesians 1–2, including the limits of claims about authority and service.

- **Study 5 — The Heavenly Calling** — Set this focused passage study within the Body's wider heavenly calling, citizenship, hope, and purpose; the larger framework gives context without supplying details Ephesians 2:6 does not state.
- **Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ** — Relate the seated position to the believer's broader standing and conduct in Christ, so positional truth and daily life are kept together without confusing them.
- **Study 57 — The Eternal Purpose of God** — Connect the Body's position in Ephesians 2:6 to the wisdom made known through the Church in Ephesians 3:10, while testing what each text actually says about authority.

Study 37 — What Does Paul Mean by “New Creation”?

What this study answers. Study 37 examines Paul’s new-creation language as an accomplished reality with individual and corporate dimensions.

- **Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ** — Start with the larger account of identity and standing in Christ; it places new creation among related blessings while Study 37 tests this expression’s particular meaning and limits.
- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Check the distinct corporate identities of Israel and the Body before assigning Israel’s prophetic restoration promises to Paul’s new creation.
- **Study 44 — Walking in the Spirit** — Distinguish this accomplished new-creation standing from the believer's ongoing, present-tense walk by the Spirit, which this study examines from Galatians 5 and Romans 8.

Study 44 — Walking in the Spirit

What this study answers. Study 44 defines what it means for a member of the Body of Christ to walk by the Spirit, and distinguishes that ongoing ministry from Israel's Acts-era signs and repeated fillings.

- **Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ** — Start with the settled identity and standing this study assumes; Study 44 examines how that standing works itself out in the believer's daily conduct.
- **Study 34 — Filled Again** — Read the Acts-era pattern of repeated, renewed fillings for Israel's apostolic servants; this study distinguishes that from the Body's settled, once-for-all indwelling.
- **Study 37 — What Does Paul Mean by “New Creation”?** — Examine the accomplished new-creation standing this study presupposes without repeating; Study 44 focuses on the present-tense walk rather than the standing itself.

Study 45 — Sanctification Under Grace

What this study answers. Study 45 distinguishes three senses of sanctification in Paul’s letters — positional, practical, and progressive — and separates the Body’s sanctification under grace from Israel’s holiness under the Mosaic Law.

- **Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ** — Start with the believer’s settled identity and standing, of which positional sanctification is one accomplished member; Study 45 isolates that member and asks what it specifically means.
- **Study 44 — Walking in the Spirit** — Read the moment-by-moment conflict between flesh and Spirit that produces the yielding Romans 6 commands; this study uses Romans 6 only for its practical-sanctification outcome.
- **Study 37 — What Does Paul Mean by “New Creation”?** — Examine the believer’s new-creation standing on its own terms; this study distinguishes that standing from the three senses of sanctification without repeating its argument.

Study 46 — Secure in Christ

What this study answers. Study 46 traces the ground of the believer's secure standing in Christ, Paul's own argument for it from the seal, the earnest, and Romans 8, and answers the hardest texts raised against it.

- **Study 16 — The Believer's Identity in Christ** — Start with the believer's settled identity in Christ, including the seal and the earnest introduced there as ground for assurance; Study 46 asks the narrower question that study leaves open, whether that standing can be lost.
- **Study 28 — The Warning of Hebrews 6:4-6** — Read the full exposition of this frequently raised warning text within its own Hebrew, covenant audience; Study 46 relies on that exposition rather than re-arguing it.
- **Study 31 — The Judgments of Scripture** — Use the broader classification of biblical judgments to keep a lost reward distinct from a lost standing, the same distinction Study 46 draws from 1 Corinthians 3:11-15 and 2 Timothy 2:12.

Study 47 — Giving Under Grace

What this study answers. Study 47 traces the pattern Paul sets for giving under grace — a willing mind measured against what a believer has, not a rate imposed from outside — administered with integrity, and distinguished from Israel's tithe under the Law.

- **Study 22 — Prayer Under Grace** — Compare another practice of the believer's daily life reframed under grace rather than under a Kingdom-era command, the same interpretive move Study 47 applies to giving.
- **Study 45 — Sanctification Under Grace** — See the same pattern applied to holiness: the Body's practice under grace is distinguished from Israel's requirement under the Mosaic Law without denying that both use similar language.
- **Study 48 — The Christian Household** — See the same "not by commandment, yet not without real accountability" pattern applied to the household code's own structure of mutual submission and self-limiting authority.

Study 48 — The Christian Household

What this study answers. Study 48 traces the household code Paul gives in Ephesians 5:15-6:9, Colossians 3:18-4:1, and 1 Timothy 5:8 — mutual submission as the hinge that governs every household pair, the heavier standard placed on whoever holds authority, and why submission is never inferiority and headship is never superiority.

- **Study 22 — Prayer Under Grace** — Compare another practice of the believer's daily life reframed under grace rather than under a Kingdom-era command, the same interpretive move this study applies to the household.
- **Study 45 — Sanctification Under Grace** — See the same pattern applied to holiness: practice flows from a standing already secured, rather than functioning as a covenant duty owed to keep it.
- **Study 47 — Giving Under Grace** — See the same "not by commandment, yet not without real accountability" pattern applied to the collection Paul entrusted to Titus and named brethren.

Study 57 — The Eternal Purpose of God

What this study answers. Study 57 traces God's purpose in Christ before the ages, the Mystery's later disclosure through Paul, and the Church's present witness of manifold wisdom before heavenly authorities. It tests the scope and limits of these claims in Ephesians 1-3.

- **Study 6 — The Mystery Revealed Through Paul** — Establish the content and timing of the Mystery's revelation first; then ask what Ephesians 3:10-11 says the disclosed Church now displays.
- **Study 5 — The Heavenly Calling** — Survey the Body's heavenly identity and blessings before connecting its calling to God's larger purpose in Christ.
- **Study 30 — Seated With Christ in Heavenly Places** — Distinguish the Body's stated present position in Ephesians 2:6 from claims about present rule or jurisdiction that Ephesians 3:10 does not itself command.
- **Study 56 — Inheritance** — Read the named heirs and objects in inheritance passages before treating Christ's comprehensive headship as a transfer of Israel's land grant.

Prophecy and future events

Which audiences and periods do prophetic passages name?

Study 3 — The Body of Christ and the Tribulation

What this study answers. Study 3 asks whether the Body of Christ belongs in Israel's coming prophetic Tribulation.

- **Study 10 — Daniel's Seventieth Week** — Establish from Daniel 9 whose people and city the seventieth week concerns; that starting point sharpens the question of whether the Body is the subject of that prophetic period.
- **Study 29 — One Taken and the Other Left** — Test a frequently cited Tribulation passage in Matthew 24 and Luke 17. Its separation scene can then be interpreted without assuming it describes the Body's gathering.

Study 7 — The Day of the Lord

What this study answers. Study 7 traces the prophetic Day of the Lord through judgment and Israel's restoration.

- **Study 8 — The Day of Christ** — Compare Paul's actual Day-of-Christ expressions with this prophetic Day, so similar sounding phrases are not assigned the same setting or every later event indiscriminately.
- **Study 3 — The Body of Christ and the Tribulation** — Consider whether the Body belongs to the prophetic Tribulation. That question matters when identifying who participates in the judgments described here.

Study 8 — The Day of Christ

What this study answers. Study 8 examines Paul's Day-of-Christ expressions and the limits of what those verses explicitly establish.

- **Study 7 — The Day of the Lord** — Set these expressions beside the prophetic Day of the Lord to keep Paul's language of completion and rejoicing distinct from Israel's judgment and restoration setting.
- **Study 31 — The Judgments of Scripture** — Place future evaluation alongside Scripture's other judgments; this prevents reward, condemnation, and prophetic judgment from being treated as a single event.

Study 10 — Daniel's Seventieth Week

What this study answers. Study 10 reads Daniel's seventieth week in relation to Daniel's people, city, and prophetic timetable.

- **Study 3 — The Body of Christ and the Tribulation** — Test whether the Body of Christ should be placed in the Tribulation that readers associate with this period; the answer depends on keeping Daniel's stated audience in view.
- **Study 7 — The Day of the Lord** — Situate the period's judgments within the wider prophetic Day of the Lord and its movement toward restoration, without flattening the two studies into the same question.

Study 23 — The 144,000

What this study answers. Study 23 identifies Revelation's numbered, sealed Israelite company in chapters 7 and 14.

- **Study 9 — The Remnant** — Compare this specifically numbered tribal company with the wider believing remnant; this prevents one group from standing in for every faithful Israelite.
- **Study 26 — The Seven Churches of Revelation** — Read the earlier messages to Revelation's seven assemblies in their own setting before connecting later scenes and groups in the book.

Study 26 — The Seven Churches of Revelation

What this study answers. Study 26 interprets Revelation's messages to seven named assemblies within their prophetic setting.

- **Study 23 — The 144,000** — Follow the separately identified 144,000 in later Revelation passages; this keeps the seven assemblies and the sealed tribal company from being assumed to be the same audience.
- **Study 10 — Daniel's Seventieth Week** — Check Daniel's stated people and period before importing a prophetic timetable into the seven letters; the comparison disciplines claims about when those messages apply.

Study 27 — Israel's Seven Appointed Feasts

What this study answers. Study 27 examines Israel's appointed feasts in their covenant calendar, their relation to Christ, and the limits of present application.

- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Use a method for learning from Israel's commands without taking over its covenant calendar; this clarifies how a feast can teach the Body without becoming its required observance.
- **Study 12 — The New Covenant** — Compare the feasts' covenant setting with Jeremiah's New Covenant recipients; this keeps Israel's ceremonial and promised restoration contexts identifiable when considering later fulfillment.

Study 29 — One Taken and the Other Left

What this study answers. Study 29 reads the 'one taken' passages in Matthew 24 and Luke 17 as prophetic separation in their immediate contexts.

- **Study 3 — The Body of Christ and the Tribulation** — Compare the Body's future hope with Israel's coming Tribulation; this explains why a separation in the prophetic discourse should not automatically be called the Body's gathering.
- **Study 7 — The Day of the Lord** — Identify the wider Day-of-the-Lord judgment setting around prophetic separation; the context sharpens who is being separated and why.
- **Study 49 — The Resurrections of Scripture** — Compare the prophetic separation traced here with the Body's own heavenly resurrection, so the two are never treated as the same event.

Study 49 — The Resurrections of Scripture

What this study answers. Study 49 traces the distinct resurrections Scripture describes — Christ's own, the Body's, and Israel's — and the Framework principle that keeps them from being flattened into one.

- **Study 31 — The Judgments of Scripture** — See the Great White Throne examined in full as a judgment; this study's interest is narrower — the resurrection that brings the unjust dead to stand before it.
- **Study 8 — The Day of Christ** — Compare Paul's Day-of-Christ language with the Body's resurrection hope traced here, both tied to glorification rather than to Israel's Kingdom.

Difficult passages and interpretive systems

How do we keep an argument's own context and question intact?

Study 15 — Faith and Works in James and Paul

What this study answers. Study 15 reads James 2 and Romans 4 according to each writer's audience, argument, and use of Abraham.

- **Study 40 — Who Is Abraham's Seed?** — Trace Paul's fuller Abraham argument across Romans and Galatians; it helps distinguish his claims about faith and heirship from the question James is answering.
- **Study 19 — The Jerusalem Council** — Examine the separate Acts 15 dispute about circumcision and the law for Gentiles; this keeps a council decision from being used as a shortcut to resolve James 2.

Study 24 — The Willful Sin Warning

What this study answers. Study 24 follows Hebrews 10:26-31 and its warning against repudiating the Son and His covenant blood.

- **Study 28 — The Warning of Hebrews 6:4-6** — Compare the earlier warning in Hebrews 6, including its land illustration; reading the two arguments separately helps identify their shared seriousness without making their every detail identical.
- **Study 12 — The New Covenant** — Review the New Covenant promise and its recipients when assessing the covenant language that makes Hebrews 10's warning so grave.

Study 28 — The Warning of Hebrews 6:4-6

What this study answers. Study 28 interprets Hebrews 6:4-6 within its argument about privilege, falling away, the land illustration, and encouragement.

- **Study 24 — The Willful Sin Warning** — Compare Hebrews 10's distinct warning about repudiating the Son and His covenant blood. The comparison shows where the warnings converge and where each passage has its own evidence and emphasis.
- **Study 31 — The Judgments of Scripture** — Use the broader classification of biblical judgments to avoid treating every warning as the same kind of future judgment.
- **Study 46 — Secure in Christ** — See how this warning's covenant audience is weighed against the Body's security under grace, and why the warning does not transfer to the Body of Christ.

Study 32 — Covenant Theology and Dispensational Theology

What this study answers. Study 32 compares how covenant theology and dispensational theology organize biblical promises, continuity, and distinctions.

- **Study 4 — Israel and the Body of Christ** — Test each system's treatment of Israel and the Body against a focused study of their corporate identities, callings, and promises; the comparison moves from labels to specific scriptural claims.
- **Study 39 — The Church's Relationship to Israel's Scriptures** — Apply an audience-sensitive reading method to Israel's earlier Scriptures; it provides a concrete test of how any larger theological system handles original recipients and present application.

Study 58 — What Is a Dispensation?

What this study answers. Study 58 reads “dispensation” as stewardship or administration in its immediate passages. It distinguishes Paul’s entrusted grace ministry, the truth revealed through him, and God’s future ordering of all things in Christ.

- **Study 6 — The Mystery Revealed Through Paul** — Identify what was hidden and then disclosed; Study 58 asks how Paul was entrusted to make that truth known for others.
- **Study 32 — Covenant Theology and Dispensational Theology** — Test wider organizing systems after the word’s particular uses have been read in context, rather than making one noun prove an entire system.
- **Study 57 — The Eternal Purpose of God** — Read the future fullness and God’s purpose in Christ without equating Ephesians 1:10 with the personal stewardship in Ephesians 3:2.
- **Study 18 — Peter and Paul: Distinct Apostolic Commissions** — Use Acts and Galatians to test the historically concurrent assignments, which a word study alone cannot establish.

Judgment and reward

How do different judgments and reward images relate?

Study 31 — The Judgments of Scripture

What this study answers. Study 31 classifies Scripture’s judgments by their subjects, timing, standards, purposes, and outcomes.

- **Study 33 — The Crowns of Scripture** — Examine crowns and rewards in their own passages; this helps locate reward language within the right evaluation instead of treating every crown as salvation or condemnation.
- **Study 8 — The Day of Christ** — Read Paul’s Day-of-Christ expressions before attaching an entire judgment scheme to them; the distinction keeps explicit wording and related future teaching in proper relation.
- **Study 46 — Secure in Christ** — See how the distinction between a lost reward and a lost standing, drawn here from 1 Corinthians 3:11–15 and 2 Timothy 2:12, secures the believer’s standing while keeping reward in its own place.

Study 33 — The Crowns of Scripture

What this study answers. Study 33 distinguishes reward crowns from other crown imagery, honor, and royal authority according to context.

- **Study 31 — The Judgments of Scripture** — Locate reward and the Judgment Seat among Scripture’s distinct judgments; this prevents a reward image from being confused with condemnation or another judgment scene.
- **Study 8 — The Day of Christ** — Check what Paul’s Day-of-Christ passages actually say about future rejoicing and completion before equating every reference with a specific crown.